

Hapoel Jerusalem

Season 2025-26 · Record 18-8 · 26 games · 2025-10-12 to 2026-05-27

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Deterministic play-by-play analytics for the current season.

Executive Summary

Hapoel Jerusalem plays an extremely slow and deliberate style of basketball, focusing heavily on controlling the tempo of the game. They are highly effective at maximizing their possessions through elite offensive rebounding and exceptional ball security, while relying heavily on drawing fouls to generate points from the free-throw line rather than scoring inside the arc. While they are dangerous when trailing due to their ability to put together massive scoring runs and convert shots efficiently, they exhibit a severe vulnerability in close, late-game situations where their shooting efficiency drops dramatically, especially in games they lose.

Game-Plan Priorities

1. Execute a disciplined half-court defense that avoids fouling and forces them into contested two-point field goals. (confidence: moderate)

Since they rely heavily on the free-throw line for scoring and rarely score from two-point range, keeping them off the line and forcing them to execute in the half-court will neutralize their primary scoring method.

Share of Points from FT 19.1% · rank 1 of 14 · league avg 16.8% · W 19.1% / L 19.0%, d=0.01 · n=26g · moderate reliability

Share of Points from 2PT 46.7% · rank 12 of 14 · league avg 50.7% · W 47.6% / L 44.8%, d=0.35 · n=26g · high reliability

Pace 75.2 · rank 12 of 14 · league avg 77.1 · W 76.0 / L 73.6, d=0.48 · n=26g · high reliability

2. Prioritize defensive rebounding block-outs and secure the defensive glass to limit their second-chance opportunities. (confidence: moderate)

They excel at maximizing possessions by securing offensive rebounds at an elite rate. We must commit all players to defensive rebounding to disrupt their possession control.

Offensive Rebound % 33.8% · rank 2 of 14 · league avg 30.3% · W 33.9% / L 32.7%, d=0.14 · n=26g · high reliability

Turnover Rate 13.4% · rank 3 of 14 · league avg 15.8% · W 12.6% / L 15.7%, d=-0.65 · n=26g · moderate reliability

3. Maintain high defensive pressure and execute late-game execution strategies to exploit their drop in shooting efficiency during close, late-game situations. (confidence: high)

They experience a substantial drop in shooting efficiency during close, late-game situations, which is a key differentiator in their losses. Keeping the game close into the final minutes plays directly into this established vulnerability.

Clutch Effective FG% 40.7% · scope clutch · rank 10 of 14 · league avg 50.2% · W 50.7% / L 30.6%, d=0.94 · n=14g · moderate reliability

4. Maintain defensive intensity and do not relax even when holding a multi-possession lead.

(confidence: moderate)

They exhibit an exceptional ability to convert shots efficiently when trailing and can put together massive scoring runs. We must remain focused to prevent them from mounting a comeback.

Effective FG% When Trailing 6+ 69.7% · scope behind_6_plus · rank 2 of 14 · league avg 60.0% · W 87.5% / L 54.4%, d=1.5 · n=13g · moderate reliability

Largest Scoring Run (per game) 10.5 · rank 1 of 14 · league avg 9.5 · W 10.7 / L 10.1, d=0.22 · n=26g · high reliability

Offensive Identity

They establish an extremely slow and deliberate tempo, preferring to control the speed of the game.

(established)

Pace 75.2 · rank 12 of 14 · league avg 77.1 · W 76.0 / L 73.6, d=0.48 · n=26g · high reliability

Their scoring profile is stylistically defined by leading the league in the share of points derived from the free-throw line while ranking near the bottom in the share of points coming from two-point field goals.

(indicated)

Share of Points from FT 19.1% · rank 1 of 14 · league avg 16.8% · W 19.1% / L 19.0%, d=0.01 · n=26g · moderate reliability

Share of Points from 2PT 46.7% · rank 12 of 14 · league avg 50.7% · W 47.6% / L 44.8%, d=0.35 · n=26g · high reliability

Strengths

They excel at maximizing possessions by securing offensive rebounds at an elite rate and maintaining excellent ball security with a low turnover rate. (indicated)

Offensive Rebound % 33.8% · rank 2 of 14 · league avg 30.3% · W 33.9% / L 32.7%, d=0.14 · n=26g · high reliability

Turnover Rate 13.4% · rank 3 of 14 · league avg 15.8% · W 12.6% / L 15.7%, d=-0.65 · n=26g · moderate reliability

They exhibit an exceptional ability to convert shots efficiently when trailing by multiple possessions, which is also reflected in their ability to put together massive scoring runs. (indicated)

Effective FG% When Trailing 6+ 69.7% · scope behind_6_plus · rank 2 of 14 · league avg 60.0% · W 87.5% / L 54.4%, d=1.5 · n=13g · moderate reliability

Largest Scoring Run (per game) 10.5 · rank 1 of 14 · league avg 9.5 · W 10.7 / L 10.1, d=0.22 · n=26g · high reliability

Vulnerabilities

They experience a substantial drop in shooting efficiency during close, late-game situations, which serves as a key differentiator in their losses. (established)

Clutch Effective FG% 40.7% · scope clutch · rank 10 of 14 · league avg 50.2% · W 50.7% / L 30.6%, d=0.94 · n=14g · moderate reliability

Turnovers

They protect the ball exceptionally well, maintaining a low turnover rate that helps them maximize their possessions. (indicated)

Offensive Rebound % 33.8% · rank 2 of 14 · league avg 30.3% · W 33.9% / L 32.7%, d=0.14 · n=26g · high reliability

Turnover Rate 13.4% · rank 3 of 14 · league avg 15.8% · W 12.6% / L 15.7%, d=-0.65 · n=26g · moderate reliability

Key Deterministic Evidence

Every value below is computed from play-by-play, not written by a model.

Metric	Scope	Value	League rank	League avg	Sample	Reliability
Pace	season	75.2	12 of 14	77.1	26g	high
Share of Points from FT	season	19.1%	1 of 14	16.8%	26g	moderate
Share of Points from 2PT	season	46.7%	12 of 14	50.7%	26g	high
Offensive Rebound %	season	33.8%	2 of 14	30.3%	26g	high
Turnover Rate	season	13.4%	3 of 14	15.8%	26g	moderate
Effective FG% When Trailing 6+	behind_6_plus	69.7%	2 of 14	60.0%	13g	moderate
Largest Scoring Run (per game)	season	10.5	1 of 14	9.5	26g	high
Clutch Effective FG%	clutch	40.7%	10 of 14	50.2%	14g	moderate

Caveats

- We lack data on rim and shot-zone shares at the season level.
- Shot distance metrics carry uncertainty and are not aggregated for the season.
- No half-court or set-offense possession type classifications are available.
- Last-passer identity and pass origin data are unavailable due to incomplete linking.
- This analysis is strictly team-level; no player-level or lineup analytics are available.
- No video-derived metrics, such as shot contest, creation, or on-ball pressure, are available.
- We cannot describe or analyze defensive schemes, coverages, or coaching intent from play-by-play data.
- The provider fast-break flag is one-directional: a False (or missing) value means only 'the provider did not classify this as a fast break'. It never means half-court, set offense, or secondary transition.
- This metric has no inherently good or bad direction. A high or low league percentile describes style, not quality, and must not be phrased as a strength or weakness.
- Segment values are the unweighted mean of per-game segment values, so a game with very few segment possessions counts as much as a game with many.

Not Available In This Data

Rim / shot-zone share (season) — Coarse shot-zone geometry is validated only at game scope and is still provisional_deterministic pending fresh blind human labelling. Season-scope aggregation was deliberately not built for this MVP checkpoint.

Shot distance — Distance carries +/-1m uncertainty (validation_state 'partial') and is not aggregated at season scope.

Half-court / set-offense possession type — No half-court classification exists. The provider fast-break flag is one-directional: its absence never implies half-court or set offense.

Last-passer identity / pass origin — Audit found a linked passer for only 38/62 made and 0/78 missed field-goal attempts. Not implemented.

Player-level and lineup analytics — This MVP is team-level only by locked product decision. No per-player claim is supportable.

Video-derived metrics (shot contest, creation, on-ball pressure) — The video layer failed reliability validation and was removed from the MVP. No video evidence exists.

Defensive scheme / coverage / play-calling — Play-by-play carries no scheme, coverage, or personnel information. Any claim about switching, drop coverage, zone, or coaching intent is unsupportable.

Automated Validation

Hard rejections: **0** · warnings: **1**

· R8: confidence 'high' exceeds weakest supporting evidence reliability 'moderate'

Methodology

Every figure in this report is computed deterministically from official play-by-play data. Language models selected, prioritized and interpreted that evidence; they did not compute any number in it, and every claim is attached to the specific deterministic measures shown beneath it. Claim strength and reliability are resolved in code from data provenance and sample size, and may only be lowered — never raised — by the interpretation step. This report is team-level and contains no player-level, scheme, or video-derived analysis.

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